



A Kitchen Table is a family conversation about money, around a shared meal, with every generation present. The first one is not about fixing anything. It is about making the family's economy visible and hearing how each generation sees it.

You will need

- A meal and a table
- As many generations as you can gather (a grandparent on a call counts)
- About an hour
- The ground rules card (01) and question cards (03)
- A first chronicle page (05)

No bank statements, no spreadsheets, no figures.

Before the day

Tell everyone the meal will include a conversation about money, and that nobody will be asked to share numbers. Anyone can call a Kitchen Table, including a teenager.

On the day

1. **Welcome.** Start the meal. Read the ground rules aloud.
2. **Round one: memories.** The oldest person answers first. Pick one or two cards, not all.
3. **Round two: habits.** About this household. Anyone may start. Children use their own cards.
4. **Round three: hopes.** The youngest answers first.
5. **Closing.** Everyone names one thing they heard that surprised them.
6. **The chronicle.** One person writes a single line: the date, who was there, and one thing the family decided or wants to remember. Never figures, never who said what.
7. **Finish the meal.** The conversation is over when the table is cleared.

If it goes badly. Silence is allowed, and so is laughing. If the talk turns to blame or old grievances, pause and return to the meal. Try again another day with memories only. Where money is tied to serious conflict, outside help may be needed first.

Next: within a few weeks, a younger family member interviews an elder using sheet 04, Money Memories.